

IMANI FRANKLIN

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Strategic leader with 10+ years of experience building talent systems and launching high-impact programs across education, HR, and civic sectors. Known for aligning people-centered practices with organizational goals to improve hiring, retention, and culture. Passionate about equity, access, and building the structures that support thriving schools, teams, and communities.

SKILLS & EXPERTISE

- Educator Pipelines & Inclusive Recruitment
- HR Systems: Workday, Zenefits, Gusto, Salesforce
- Talent Strategy & Stakeholder Engagement
- Program Design & Continuous Improvement
- Data-Informed Hiring & Evaluation
- Cross-Sector Partnerships & Career Pathways

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Recruitment Consultant

March 2021 - Present

New Schools for New Orleans

- Led citywide recruitment operations, resulting in 600+ reported hires and a 15%+ conversion rate from a 6,000+ candidate pool
- Built and refined resume-sharing systems to improve hiring speed and match quality across partner schools
- Forged strategic partnerships with TNTP, REACH University, and school leaders to strengthen the talent pipeline
- Produced recruitment events, onboarding materials, and retention supports for school leaders

Residency Program Manager

March 2021 - Sept 2023

Xavier University of Louisiana X NSNO

- Managed recruitment and admissions for a multi-year teacher residency initiative, enrolling 20 and 15 residents in back-to-back cohorts and re-establishing strong program momentum
- Increased Black male educator representation by 25%, helping shift the demographic balance in residency cohorts through targeted outreach and HBCU partnerships
- Collaborated with University admissions to ensure timely candidate acceptance into Graduate Program (M.A.T)
- Fostered cross-sector collaboration between faculty, mentors, and school systems to support residency success

Operations & Donor Strategy Consultant

June 2024- Present

Louisiana Alliance

- Co-led day-to-day operations and strategic planning alongside the Executive Director and Design Team
- Developed internal systems and donor-facing materials to streamline engagement, event logistics, and communications
- Led the full executive search process for the Alliance's inaugural Executive Director — from outreach through onboarding
- Helped coordinate strategy sessions, funder briefings, and convenings to strengthen collaboration between grassroots organizers and funders

Inaugural HR Director

May 2021 - May 2022

Hotel Peter & Paul

- Established the hotel's first HR department, designing systems and policies that balanced boutique hospitality values with regulatory compliance and long-term staff development
- Served as a key advisor to ownership during a period of rapid growth, providing guidance on workforce structure, risk management, and employee relations
- Implemented employee engagement and professional development strategies that improved morale and reduced turnover
- Cultivated a positive workplace culture rooted in communication, care, and accountability, while navigating the operational needs of a co-owner-led leadership structure

PBIS Coordinator

Aug 2018 - May 2021

Ben Franklin Elementary School (K-8)

- Established a schoolwide PBIS framework that improved student culture and reduced behavior referrals
- Delivered training and coaching to 70+ educators on trauma-informed behavior support
- Led student and family engagement programming that built stronger school-community ties
- Used behavior data to inform interventions and guide leadership decision-making

Human Resources Associate

May 2016 - July 2018

Green Dot Public Schools

- Supported HR operations for 2,500+ employees across three states with a focus on onboarding, compliance, and retention
- Administered benefits, ADA cases, and leave tracking while supporting Workday HRIS integration
- Provided guidance to school leaders on employee relations best practices and conflict resolution
- Helped launch tools and workflows to improve hiring timelines and candidate experience

EDUCATION

Master of Social Work (MSW)

2016

University of Southern California

- Major in Business in a Global Society

Bachelor of Arts in Health & Human Services

2014

St. John's University

HIGHLIGHTS

- Delivered 600+ educator placements across 90+ New Orleans school sites (2021–2024), improving year-over-year hiring consistency and access
- Strengthened teacher residency recruitment, increasing Black male educator participation by 25% through culturally responsive outreach and partnerships with HBCUs
- Established foundational HR systems at a boutique hotel during its launch and expansion, improving morale, retention, and compliance
- Supported strategy and operations for a statewide civic coalition, including a successful executive search and cross-sector funder alignment